

THE CHAPEL

Trinity Term 2026



An eye for beauty: Carved pew-end in the Chapel photographed by the illustrator & designer Bev Saunders (aka Lady Shadbolt) who features in this term's Faith & Vocation series

Welcome back! I hope you've had a good break. I spent mine in and out of football stadia - mostly at Sincil Bank, the spiritual home of my beloved Imps, otherwise known as Lincoln City FC - pursuing an elusive, lifelong goal. In this beautiful Cathedral city, happily my birthplace, the Promised Land was finally in sight at Easter. As Good Friday's three-hour devotion ended, the Imps kicked off against AFC Wimbledon knowing that a win would put us on the very brink of promotion to the EFL Championship and could even (if other results went our way) 'land us safe on Canaan's side' by supper. The last time success-starved Lincoln played in the second-tier of English football Spurs were doing the double. The Berlin Wall was not quite built, the American nightmare was Cuba rather than Iran and Yuri Gagarin was about to become the first human in space. 65 years in the wilderness has been far too long.

For my part, I jumped aboard the Lincoln loco when a short-lived revival saw us top the third tier in March 1982. But alas the promotion push hit the buffers and petered out again twelve months later. Then came a drop through the divisions, even banishment unto the 'outer darkness' of non-league, that hapless place of 'wailing and gnashing of teeth' ... and, with the Fall, financial peril, fractious infighting, administration and a marked malaise in everything



surrounding the club. But, in the last decade, with good governance and inspired, innovative leadership at last taking root, increasing numbers of us yellowbellies began daring to believe that our entire lives might not in fact be spent in football's basement. Cue a new manager, ex-PE teacher Danny Cowley - if not The Messiah then certainly a Moses pointing us in the right direction, a forerunner like John the Baptist, engaging the community, prophesying salvation. FA Cup quarter-finalists in 2017, title winners the same year and again in 2019,

with EFL Trophy success at Wembley sandwiched in-between, Cowley stayed long enough to drag us up into League One again. A Play-off Final followed in 2021, and although lost, the feeling grew that, given modest foreign investment and with an elite futsal coach (Michael Skubala) freshly appointed, the stars might one day align.

In the event, they didn't on Good Friday ... not quite. Ironically, Bishop in the Wimbledon goal - booked for time wasting no less - kept City's forwards at bay. And although one of our super-subs broke the deadlock late on, Lincoln's closest rivals for promotion also triumphed, and so the Promised Land remained a gnat's whisker away. A single point at Reading on Easter Monday would, however, suffice. This seemed fitting. In the Cathedral, the Dean had warned us not to hasten the resurrection. Human beings, he said, in their anxiety much prefer resolution to uncertainty. But Good Friday can't be hurried. It is a day for empathy, for recognising the griefs and grievances that so often shape our short stint on this planet. It is a day not for looking ahead but for looking around.

Wise words. At Sincil Bank, I scanned the fraught, friendly faces of ten thousand souls whose hopes and dreams I have for so long shared. What I had hoped would come to pass aged sixteen has taken me till sixty to behold. But perhaps the long wait makes it sweeter still. As does its realisation at Easter, when 'healed, restored, forgiven' we can all enjoy the promise of promotion to dizzyingly new heights of humanity. And so it proved! At Reading, the Red Imps picked up more than a point. Gloriously, we took all three, with a last-gasp winner scored right in front of the travelling faithful. Absolute scenes! Mission accomplished, the Promised Land reached! Let the Impvasion begin ...

Is this my life's vocation? I couldn't possibly say! But I do know that by instinct and personality I am well disposed to being a supporter. It makes service in the church and through chaplaincy a good fit. Lean on me, I'm a (Har)bridge over troubled waters etc. Indeed, *Faith & Vocation* happens to be this term's Evensong theme. Shelby Knighten framed it well in a recent address: *In the synagogue, 30-year-old Jesus at the beginning of his ministry puts forward a clear vision of what He is called to do: bringing 'good news to the poor,' 'proclaiming release to the captives,' setting the oppressed free. He doesn't say, 'The Lord has called me to be a rabbi, teacher, doctor, political revolutionary ...' Jesus doesn't profess a career; instead, he speaks of his vocation. And the wait between the dream and its disclosure is the time to discern it.*

Philip

WEEK BY WEEK

Sunday 5.45pm Evensong

The Chapel's main weekly service, with beautiful music and excellent speakers; also available online

Weekdays 9.00-9.30am Morning Prayer

Led by the Chaplain on Mondays but the Chapel is always booked at this time for quiet reflection

Tuesday 2.30-3.30pm Drop-in Donuts

Pop into 14.2 in Third Quad for a tasty treat; no faith affiliation required, just a sweet tooth

Wednesday 12.05pm Eucharist

A short, simple service of Holy Communion – no hymns, no sermon, no demands

Thursday 8.15pm Night Song

A short meditative service of Compline with psalms and prayers for the end of the day

SUNDAY CHORAL EVENSONGS

Career We Go!

Faith & Vocation

Evensong takes place in Chapel on Sundays at 5.45pm unless otherwise stated. Sung by the Choir, it offers beautiful music and compelling speakers. Students of all faiths and none find hope and solace here. Afterwards, you can chat to our guest speaker over sherry in the Harold Wilson Room. Services are also streamed on our YouTube channel.

26 April **Fourth Sunday of Easter (5.30pm)**

God and the Journalist

**Preacher: Melanie McDonagh, Columnist & Feature Writer at the Evening Standard
The Press – profession adrift, feeling the squeeze?**

3 May **Fifth Sunday of Easter**

God and the Rule of Law

**Simon Lee, Emeritus Professor of Jurisprudence, Queen's University Belfast
How did Newman fare in Finals, in life after Finals and in the after-life?**

10 May **Sixth Sunday of Easter**

God and the Medics

**Dr Antonio Cosimetti, Consultant in Acute General Medicine and Geratology
Arun Joseph, Critical Care Physiotherapist & DPhil Scholar in Clinical Neurosciences
Quo vadis?**

17 May **Sunday after the Ascension**

God and the Mediaeval Baebe

**Reverend Emily Kolltveit, Vicar of St Jude on the Hill, Hampstead Garden Suburb
Hearing God's voice most clearly – from Heavy Metal to Handel's Messiah**

24 May **Pentecost**

God and Military Defence

**The Venerable Canon Jonathan Chaffey, Archdeacon of Oxford
Mobilising a Great Army of Believers**

31 May **Trinity Sunday**

God and the BBC

**Reverend Stephen Lynas, Retired Bishops' Chaplain
Words, images and music – an unholy Trinity?**

7 June **First Sunday after Trinity**

God and the Designer

**Bev Saunders, Fellow of the Royal Society of Arts
Imagine what if ...**

14 June **Second Sunday after Trinity / Levensong (5.30pm)**

God and the Future of Artificial Intelligence

**Professor Sir Nigel Shadbolt, Jesus College Principal & Professorial Research Fellow
Should we put our faith in AI?**

PEOPLE

The Chaplain (Revd Philip Harbridge) is an Anglican priest and – as part of the Welfare Team – he's here for all members of College, regardless of faith or background. If you want to talk something over, great or small, Philip offers a willing ear. Please don't hesitate to drop by his office (Staircase XIV.2) in Third Quad, or email (chaplain@jesus.ox.ac.uk) or phone (279757) him.

Director of Chapel Music: Peter Parshall (peter.parshall@jesus.ox.ac.uk)

Organ Scholar: Helena Ramsden

College Organist: Conrad Spencer

Chapel Clerks: Ethan McGeorge, Marcus Arnold and Yannick Fiss

Christian Union: Matthew King

Roman Catholic Rep: Monica Fox

SPECIAL EVENTS

These 'red-letter' days are a mix of the secular and religious, marked by an installation, a talk or a service, some distinctive to particular faiths or traditions, others an opportunity for sharing across 'borders'. In each case, please look out for publicity a week or so in advance.

28 April	Commemoration of Benefactors
1 May	Beltane (Pagan) celebrating peak spring & the coming of summer
1 May	Vesak (Buddhist) marking Buddha's birth, enlightenment and death
6 May	'Jigsaw': Christians Together – A Service & Supper
7 May	Vesak Formal
11-17 May	Mental Health Awareness Week
13 May	College Mass, Our Lady of Fatima
14 May	Ascension Day (6.30pm Sung Eucharist)
20 May	Shavuot Dinner
21 May	Shavuot (Jewish) marking the giving of the Torah at Mount Sinai
24 May	Pentecost
24-29 May	Hajj (Muslim), annual Islamic pilgrimage to Mecca
26-30 May	Eid-al-Adha (Muslim) honouring the obedience of Ibrahim
31 May	Trinity Sunday
11 June	Interfaith Walk of Peace (6pm)
11 June	Pride Dinner
15 June	Interfaith Picnic with Cricket
18 June	Pride Picnic
20 June	Wedding of Dr Adam Lovett and Dr Petra Paizs
27 June	Baptism of Clara Elizabeth Wellner James

THE CHAPEL

The Chapel is open all day: a house of prayer and a place of peace and stillness for everyone.

MULTI FAITH ROOM

This can be found on the stairs up to Fourth Quad. It is a shared, neutral space intended for anyone to pray, reflect or just be quiet. Prayer mats are available in the cupboards. Recent enhancements include 'mood' lighting, greenery and further seats, plus a growing library of books.

JIGSAW

A termly gathering for those of different faiths or denominations to piece together a life in common

LUNCHTIME RECITALS

Music recitals take place in Chapel on Thursday lunchtimes, 1.15-2.00pm.

KEYBOARDS FOR PRACTICE

A piano and harpsichord are available in Chapel but must be booked with the Chaplain before use.